



“ **PEACEFUL** TRANSFER OF AUTHORITY IS **RARE** IN HISTORY, YET **COMMON** IN OUR COUNTRY. WITH A **SIMPLE OATH**, WE AFFIRM OLD TRADITIONS, AND MAKE **NEW BEGINNINGS**. ”

George W. Bush, opening his inauguration speech, January 20, 2001



and supporter of al-Qaeda, was sentenced to life imprisonment.

As the terrorist threat from al-Qaeda took center stage, the **Irish Republican Army (IRA)** made an historic announcement. On October 23, it stated that it had begun to **disarm** and had put some of its weapons “beyond use.”

In India, the state of **Gujarat** was rocked by an **earthquake** on January 26, which registered 7.9 on the Richter scale. More than 20,000 people died and 400,000 homes were destroyed.

The free online encyclopedia “**Wikipedia**” was launched on January 15 by Jimmy Wales and Larry Sanger. By the end of the year, it held more than 20,000 articles in 18 languages. Articles are written by volunteers and can be edited by anyone.

The **Human Genome Project (HGP)** aimed to identify all the genes in the human body. In February, the HGP published its first draft: a 90-percent complete sequence of all three billion base pairs in the human genome.

US technology company, **Apple**, had high hopes for its new digital music player, the **iPod**, which was launched on October 23. The device could store hundreds of music tracks, yet was around the same size as a pack of cards.

Terror attack

Hijacked United Airlines Flight 175 crashed into the South Tower of the World Trade Center and exploded, killing hundreds of people.

